This is a lexicographical sort; the strings have been arranged in alphabetical order (A–Z first, then a–z second). If we were to use digits, they would be placed before alphabet characters, with punctuation placed before digits:

```
$things = ['Zebra', 'Apple', '.-Orange', '0-banana'];
// sort() and print_r() ...
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => .-Orange
    [1] => 0-banana
    [2] => Apple
    [3] => Zebra
)
```

This works because ASCII was designed with this kind of operation in mind: the ASCII code page is organized in (English) lexicographical order. At no point during execution of the above code has PHP become aware of the English language, and the internal logic of `sort()` is predicated purely on the byte values in the buffers. Let's write that code one more time, but using ASCII (and therefore UTF-8) byte values…

```
$things = [
    "\x5a\x65\x62\x72\x61", // Zebra
    "\x41\x70\x70\x6c\x65", // Apple
    "\x2e\x2d\x4f\x72\x61\x6e\x67\x65", // .-Orange
    "\x30\x2d\x62\x61\x6e\x61\x6e\x61" // 0-banana
];
sort($things);
print_r($things);
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => .-Orange
    [1] => 0-banana
    [2] => Apple
    [3] => Zebra
)
```